

Mergers & Acquisitions

UPS industry going in for consolidation

For the past few years, the UPS industry has been in for a change. Most small, local manufacturers have ceased to exist, while big local players have been bought over by multinational companies. Many mid-size local manufacturers exist, but to ensure their survival, they need to take a technology leap. Obviously,

advanced technologies cannot be developed overnight. These will have to be acquired from other high-tech companies in the field.

The latest on this front is France-based Legrand's acquisition of the UPS division of India's Numeric Power Systems. This acquisition includes Numeric's Sri Lanka and Singapore operations and follows the earlier acquisition of Luminous (Power Technologies) by

Schneider Electric last year.

The deal is expected to strengthen Legrand's presence in India through Numeric Power's sales and service network, according to Anindya Das, Industry Manager (Energy and Power Systems Practice) at Frost and Sullivan, South Asia, Middle East and North Africa. Das expects more consolidation in the UPS industry in the next two years.

Manufacturing

Heading towards green revolution

All the manufacturing is focused on eco-friendly products. These products are being designed on energy-efficient technologies, with minimal losses of energy at every stage. Small footprint, high power density and high reliability of manufacturing are the other key trends.

While the basic power switching circuit remains almost the same, switching losses are reducing with improvised devices. For small and medium power range, the use of SiC MOSFET switching is expected in the near future. This will improve the overall conversion efficiency of many topologies.

Space optimisation has permeated organisations of all sizes, generating more demand for rack-based UPS systems for rack closets. Manufacturers are moving away from large standalone systems to fulfill cus-

tomers' expectations. They are preferring rack-mount/modular design, transformerless technology with unity input and output power factors, less than 5 per cent total harmonic distortion of current (THDi) and efficiency in excess of 94 per cent. New technology also offers N+1 redundancy, hot swappable power, control and battery modules, mean time to repair (MTTR) of less than 30 minutes, concurrent maintenance capabilities, etc.

Further, as IT and physical infrastructure come to coexist in containment, monitoring solutions are increasingly being bundled with UPS systems. Intelligent integrated infrastructure solutions can, for example, alert if a battery cell is damaging an entire string or a single dirty solar panel reducing the output of an entire array. These can also adjust cooling operation if the load or temperatures vary.

